

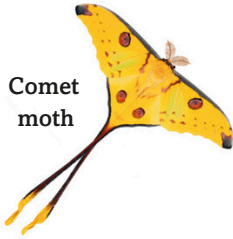
Madagascar



Africa



Panther chameleon



Comet moth

Madagascan wildlife

Wildlife found only on the island includes about 40 species of lemur, about half of the world's chameleons, and a large moth called the comet moth.



Ring-tailed lemur



Colorful lambas

The Sakalava people are one of many Malagasy ethnic groups. Traditionally, men and women wear a wraparound cloth called a lamba.



- 📏 226,658 sq miles (587,041 sq km)
- 👤 27 million
- ★ Antananarivo
- 🗨️ Malagasy, French, English

The pods are the fruit of the vanilla orchid.



Vanilla pods

More than two-thirds of the global supply of vanilla is produced in Madagascar.



0 100 km
0 100 miles
(approximate scale)

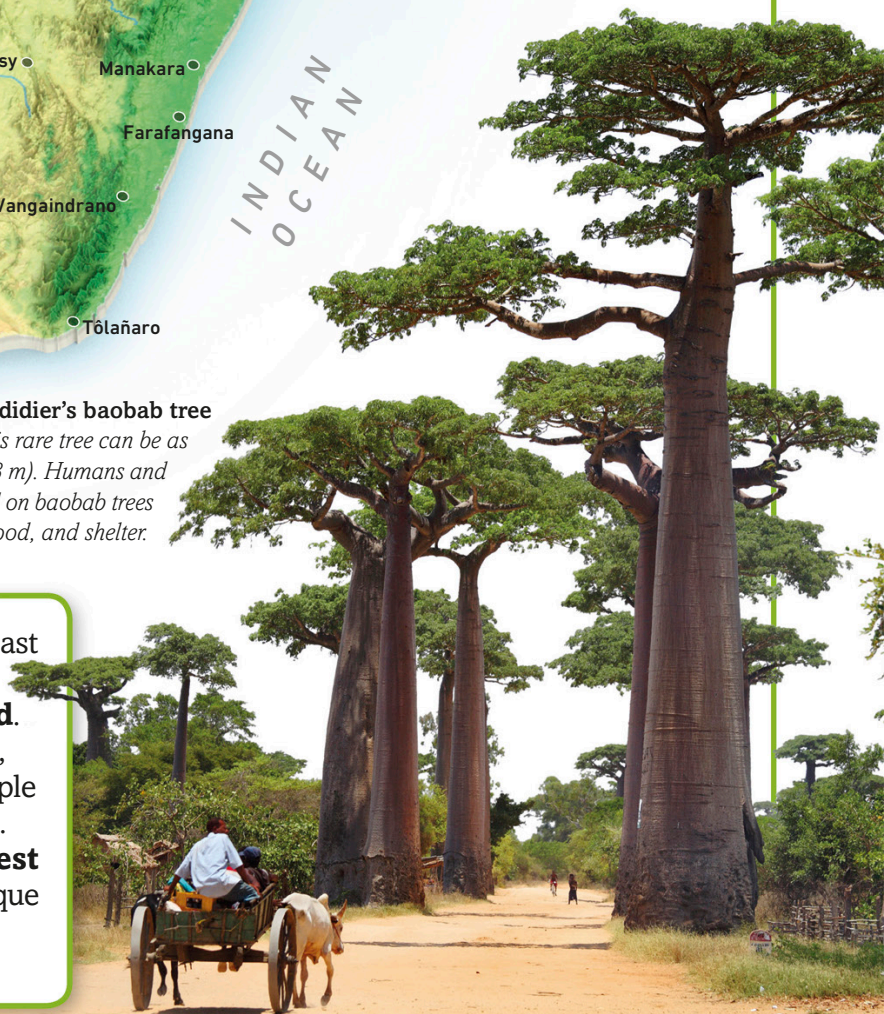
Solar energy

Power supplies are limited on the island, but year-round sunshine means solar power plants can harness the abundant sunlight to generate renewable energy.



Grandidier's baobab tree

The trunk of this rare tree can be as wide as 10 ft (3 m). Humans and animals depend on baobab trees for water, food, and shelter.



Situated off Africa's southeast coast, Madagascar is the world's **fifth-largest island**. First settled around 500 CE, its **ethnically diverse** people came from Asia and Africa. Its **isolation** and **rain forest habitats** have allowed unique **flora** and **fauna** to evolve.